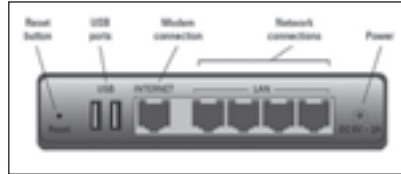


tions that came with the router for specifics on how things are set up, but generally the ethernet cables from your PCs hook into the LAN connectors. A single connector is designated for the broadband modem, which also plugs into the router by using an ethernet cable.

Some routers come with on/off switches. Nowadays you just need to plug the router into the wall socket to turn it on. There's no need to turn off the router unless you're troubleshooting the network or you plan on not



The back of a Router

using the network for an extended period; most people just leave their broadband modems and routers on all the time. Another important item you need to locate on your router is its reset switch. It's probably located on the back of the router. The reset switch is most likely recessed.

The front of the router is far less interesting than the back. The front features a few lamps that flicker as traffic flows into and out of the router, plus perhaps a status light or three.

Setting up your router

Now you'll learn how to set up a Wi-Fi router to use with your laptop. In general, this process begins by connecting the router to the same computer that is attached to your broadband modem (in this example, your laptop); this allows automated configuration software to obtain the information it needs without any intermediary devices along the way.

Here's a typical setup:

- ▶ The first thing you need to do is turn off the power to your broadband modem. If your modem doesn't have an on/off switch, remove the power supply to the device.
- ▶ Now, connect the power adapter to the back panel of the wireless router.
- ▶ Plug this adapter into any AC outlet and make sure that the power LED illuminates.
- ▶ Once you've ensured that the power LED is glowing, connect an ethernet cable to the broadband modem.
- ▶ Restore power back to the modem.
- ▶ Insert the other end of the ethernet cable into the WAN (wide area network) port on the back panel of the wireless router.